

United States Citizenship and Immigration Services (Simulated Notice)

Request for Evidence (Training Simulation)

Form I-140, Immigrant Petition for Alien Worker
Classification sought: **E11 - Alien of Extraordinary Ability**

Simulated Notice Date:	December 18, 2025
Response Due Date:	March 16, 2026
Receipt Number:	IOE2591234567
A-Number:	A209-558-014
Petitioner:	HelioDx Analytics, Inc.
Beneficiary:	Dr. Karina Solene Velasquez
Petitioner Address:	8800 Bayfront Parkway, Suite 420, San Diego, CA 92121
Beneficiary Address:	c/o HelioDx Analytics, Inc., 8800 Bayfront Parkway, Suite 420, San Diego, CA 92121
Drafty QA Case ID:	DRAFTY-QA-2025-12-30-001

Your organization, **HelioDx Analytics, Inc.** (petitioner), filed Form I-140, Immigrant Petition for Alien Worker, seeking E11 immigrant classification for **Dr. Karina Solene Velasquez** (beneficiary) on **September 9, 2025**. The petitioner intends to employ the beneficiary as a/an **Principal Scientist, Computational Pathology** in the field of **computational pathology and machine learning for oncology diagnostics**.

The E11 immigrant classification applies to individuals with extraordinary ability in the sciences, arts, education, business, or athletics. The beneficiary must demonstrate sustained national or international acclaim and show that their achievements have been recognized in the field of expertise, indicating that they are among the small percentage who have risen to the very top of their field. The beneficiary must intend to continue work in the area of extraordinary ability and must prospectively benefit the United States.

To continue processing this petition and determine eligibility, we require additional evidence. You may submit any credible, relevant evidence. However, the petitioner is responsible for demonstrating, by a preponderance of the evidence, that the beneficiary met all requirements at the time the petition was filed.

1. Intent to Continue Work in the Claimed Area of Expertise

The record does not establish that the beneficiary will continue working in the claimed area of expertise in the United States. While the petition states that the beneficiary will serve as a Principal Scientist, Computational Pathology, the evidence submitted does not include a detailed statement of planned work, a current employer support letter describing specific projects, or other documentation showing ongoing or prospective engagements in the field.

Please submit evidence establishing that the beneficiary is coming to the United States to continue work in the field in which the beneficiary has garnered acclaim. Evidence may include:

- Letter(s) from the current or prospective U.S. employer describing specific duties, projects, and how they relate to the beneficiary's claimed area of expertise.
- An employment contract or offer letter with detailed terms and role description.
- A detailed statement from the beneficiary describing planned work activities in the United States, including anticipated collaborators, venues, and timelines.

2. Extraordinary Ability Analysis

USCIS applies a two-part analysis when evaluating extraordinary ability petitions. First, we determine whether the petitioner has submitted evidence of either a one-time achievement (a major internationally recognized award) or evidence satisfying at least three of the regulatory criteria. Second, we evaluate the totality of the evidence to determine whether it demonstrates sustained national or international acclaim and that the beneficiary is among the small percentage at the very top of the field.

A. One-time Achievement (Major, Internationally Recognized Award)

The petitioner submitted evidence of the beneficiary receiving the *International Radiomics Society Gold Medal* (Exhibit D-3) as a one-time achievement. The current record does not establish that this award is a major, internationally recognized award in the field. The evidence provided does not include information regarding the award's selection criteria, the scope of eligible nominees, the reputation of the granting organization, or prior recipients who enjoyed international acclaim at the time of receipt.

If you contend this award is a major, internationally recognized award, submit documentary evidence demonstrating:

- The award is widely recognized internationally as one of the top awards in the relevant field.
- The criteria and process used to select recipients, including the composition and qualifications of the selection panel.
- The geographic scope of competition and typical nominee pool.
- Information about prior recipients and their level of acclaim at the time of the award.

B. Regulatory Criteria

The petition must satisfy at least three of the regulatory criteria if a one-time major award is not established. The evidence in the record is discussed below.

(i) Lesser Nationally or Internationally Recognized Prizes or Awards for Excellence

The petitioner submitted the following as evidence for this criterion:

- a) *Pacific Coast Digital Pathology Challenge - First Place* (2024) (Exhibit C-1)
- b) *Andes Biomedical AI Innovation Prize* (2023) (Exhibit C-2).

The current record does not establish that these prizes are nationally or internationally recognized awards for excellence in the field. The evidence does not show the geographic scope of the competition, the reputation of the granting bodies, the selection criteria, or prior winners.

To establish this criterion, you may submit evidence such as:

- Official award descriptions, selection criteria, and nomination or eligibility requirements.

- Information about the granting organization and its reputation in the field.
- The geographic scope of candidates and number of awards granted annually.
- Lists of prior recipients and evidence that recipients are recognized nationally or internationally.

(ii) Membership in Associations that Require Outstanding Achievements

The petitioner provided proof of membership in the International Society for Computational Pathology (ISCP) and the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) (Exhibits C-5 and C-6). The record does not establish that these memberships require outstanding achievements of members, as judged by recognized national or international experts. The evidence submitted reflects standard professional membership levels and does not include bylaws or membership criteria showing that admission is based on outstanding achievements.

If you contend that the beneficiary's membership satisfies this criterion, submit:

- The association's constitution or bylaws showing the criteria for the beneficiary's level of membership.
- Evidence that outstanding achievements are required and that applications are reviewed by recognized experts.
- Information establishing the expertise and qualifications of the reviewing panel.

(iii) Published Material About the Beneficiary in Professional or Major Trade Publications or Other Major Media

The petitioner submitted two online articles (Exhibits B-2 and B-3) that reference the beneficiary as part of a team announcement for a commercial product launch. The record does not establish that these materials are published in professional or major trade publications or other major media, nor that the materials are primarily about the beneficiary and the beneficiary's work in the field. General corporate marketing materials are not generally considered published material about the beneficiary. To establish this criterion, you may submit:

- Published articles or profiles that focus primarily on the beneficiary and describe the beneficiary's work in the field.
- Evidence of the publication's circulation, readership, or audience, specific to the medium in which it was published.
- The title, date, and author of each submitted piece.

(iv) Participation as a Judge of the Work of Others

The petitioner provided email invitations for the beneficiary to serve as a peer reviewer for multiple journals and conference program committees (Exhibits C-9 through C-12). However, the record does not include evidence that the beneficiary actually completed reviews or served on a judging panel. Invitations alone are insufficient to establish participation.

Submit evidence establishing actual participation, such as:

- Editorial or program committee confirmations showing completed reviews, including dates and the name of the journal or conference.
- Reviewer acknowledgments published by journals or conferences listing the beneficiary.
- Screenshots or system records from manuscript management platforms showing completed reviews, with identifying information redacted as appropriate.

(v) Original Contributions of Major Significance

The petitioner asserts that the beneficiary made original contributions through the development of a weakly supervised tumor segmentation method used in the petitioner's diagnostic workflow (Exhibits D-1 and D-2). The current record does not establish that the claimed contributions are of major significance in the field. The evidence provided is largely internal, and it does not demonstrate that the work has been widely implemented by others, widely cited, or recognized by independent experts as a major contribution.

To establish major significance, you may submit evidence such as:

- Independent expert letters that identify specific contributions and explain, with detail, how those contributions are original and of major significance.
- Objective evidence of adoption or implementation by other organizations, such as licenses, contracts, or technical integrations.
- Citation data, independent evaluations, or industry guidelines that reference or rely on the beneficiary's work.
- Patents that are granted and evidence of current utilization in the field.

(vi) Authorship of Scholarly Articles

The petitioner submitted copies of three articles and a partial publication list (Exhibits A-1 through A-4). The record appears incomplete and does not provide a complete record of the beneficiary's scholarly articles. Additionally, the petitioner has not provided evidence establishing that the venues in which the articles were published qualify as professional or major trade publications or other major media.

Please submit a complete record of scholarly articles, such as:

- Search results from a scholarly index (for example, PubMed or Google Scholar) showing the beneficiary as author, article title, and publication venue.
- For each article, the pages necessary to show the beneficiary as author, the title, and the journal or publication.
- Evidence demonstrating the professional or major trade nature of the publication venue, including circulation or audience information where applicable.

(viii) Leading or Critical Role for Distinguished Organizations

The petitioner states that the beneficiary has performed in a critical role for HelioDx Analytics, Inc. and for the Open Pathology Standards Consortium (Exhibits E-1 and E-2). The current record does not establish that the beneficiary's role was leading or critical, as described in the regulation, nor does it establish that the named organizations have a distinguished reputation in the field. The letters provided contain general statements and do not provide detailed, probative information regarding the

beneficiary's specific accomplishments compared to others in similar roles.

To establish this criterion, you may submit:

- Organizational charts, position descriptions, and documentation showing where the beneficiary fits within the organization's structure.
- Detailed letters from individuals with personal knowledge explaining how the beneficiary's work was critical to outcomes.
- Evidence of the organizations' distinguished reputation, such as industry rankings, major contracts, significant media coverage, or notable awards.

(ix) High Salary or Other Significantly High Remuneration

The petitioner submitted an offer letter and a compensation summary (Exhibits F-1 and F-2). The evidence does not establish that the beneficiary's salary or remuneration is significantly high in relation to others in the field. The record does not include comparable wage data, tax forms, or independent compensation surveys to support a relative comparison.

To establish this criterion, you may submit:

- W-2, 1099, or equivalent foreign tax documents for years in which the beneficiary earned the claimed wages.
- Position and geography appropriate compensation surveys from credible sources, along with an explanation of how the beneficiary compares.
- Evidence of bonuses, equity awards, consulting fees, or other remuneration relevant to total compensation.

3. Translations

Any document containing foreign language text must be accompanied by a full English translation. The translator must certify that the translation is complete and accurate, and that the translator is competent to translate from the foreign language into English.

4. Summary and Response Instructions

Based on the current record, the petition does not establish eligibility under the E11 classification. You must respond to this notice by the response due date listed above. If you do not respond, or if the response does not establish eligibility, the petition may be denied.

Your response should include a cover letter that identifies the receipt number, the beneficiary, and a table of contents that clearly labels each exhibit. Submit copies of requested evidence unless originals are specifically required. Do not submit irreplaceable originals.

End of simulated notice.